



Serum Sensitivity Test

A Serum Sensitivity Test will be performed at the first initial consultation **AND** any time you plan to change or bump up the strength of a serum. You will always base your **serum recommendations** on the results of the **Serum Sensitivity Test**. You **MUST** test your client's skin to determine which serum their skin can tolerate.

Knowing your client's tolerance will guide you in making the most compatible choices for their skin. Make sure the client's home care routine is not too strong. **More is not better**. If the home care routine is too strong, the products will eventually dehydrate and/or burn the skin and will impede the clearing process.

STEPS FOR PERFORMING THE TEST:

- 1 Cleanse with **Ultra Gentle Cleanser** and tone with **Moisture Balance Toner** or **Soothing Radiance Toner**.
- 2 Apply **8% L-Mandelic Serum** to the lower side of the left cheek for inflamed, combination and moderate/severe noninflamed. Test **Retinal B3 Serum** for mild noninflamed.
- 3 Ask if they feel any tingling, and if they do, ask, "On a scale of one to ten, one being you hardly feel anything and ten being very irritating, what number would you give it?"
- 4 If the client feels a 2 or less, proceed to **Step 7** below. If they feel more than a 2, you will then test the **5% L-Mandelic Serum** for inflamed or combination acne on the opposite lower cheek. If you get a number higher than 3, cleanse the serum off with water.
- 5 If you are proceeding to the other cheek to test **5% L-Mandelic**, ask if the client feels any tingling and if so, what degree of tingling they feel. If they feel a 2 or less, then that is the serum they will use. If you get a number higher than 3, cleanse the serum off with water.
- 6 If the client feels more than a 2 with both **8% and 5% L-Mandelic Serums**, see **step 8**.
- 7 Once you find a serum that the client feels at a 2 or less, put the serum all over their face and ask if they still feel the same degree of tingling just to be sure that the client can tolerate it. **If they feel a number higher than 3, cleanse the serum off with water and (see step 8) and proceed with a treatment if planned. You do not need to apply the Glycolic-Lactic Toner prior to a peel.**



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If a client cannot tolerate any serum (feels over a 2 on a 1-10 scale of tingling, stinging, and/or burning), don't give them one. Have them follow the home care instructions for Week 1 & 2, minus the serum. Most of the time, **Advanced Acne Med** (benzoyl peroxide) will make their skin less sensitive over time and you can test their skin for a serum again in 2 weeks.

****IMPORTANT** – If they feel a 0 with 8% L-Mandelic Serum, there is no need to test anything higher on the face. We have found that even if they can tolerate the higher strengths, they are too drying in the beginning.